



HTC Runnymede

HTC Runnymede, an Android 2.3 powered device, will be called HTC Sensation XL and not HTC Bass, like rumoured earlier

Mobile watch

Samsung BADA

Bada is a linux based OS developed by Samsung for, as they put it, "a smartphone for everyone". It was in 2010 that Samsung announced their first Bada 1.0 powered device. When the OS was first launched, it was a very basic OS with just the bare essential features to classify it as a smartphone. With the upgrade to Bada 2.0, the OS is right up there with all the big guns of the smartphone world. The



update brings with it speech recognition, multitasking, a full-fledged web browser with flash support, NFC, Push notifications and many more. The app marketplace has also slowly been growing and now includes over 7,000 apps. Samsung has announced plans to make this OS open source and to also integrate it into their upcoming Smart TVs as well. Overall, this OS does have a lot of potential. How the public receives it remains to be seen.

Android

Android is a comparatively new entrant in the smartphone OS arena, but has risen to popularity at such a rapid rate that it has acquired almost half the smartphone market share in the world. The comparatively rapid update cycle meant that despite a rocky start, the OS now sets the norm as far as the mobile OS is concerned. Android has gained a lot of popularity and has completely dethroned Nokia and is slowly eating its way into Apple's, previously untouchable, market share. Now with the release of Android v4.0, the OS is packed to the brim with every feature you can think off, flash support, apps, "goggles", NFC (Android Beam), threaded



messaging, tethering, face recognition and many more. The v4.0 upgrade is supposed to be a merger of Honeycomb and Gingerbread. The upgrade does not seem like anything much when compared to the iOS 5 or Mango updates, but this is because the OS already had most of those features integrated to begin with. This OS is here to stay and is only getting better with time.

BlackBerry OS

The ubiquitous businessman's smartphone, BlackBerry did to email what apple did to music. BlackBerry tightly integrates its OS with its devices and tries to ensure quality "push" mail service no matter what. Now, with almost every service that a BlackBerry



provides available on most smartphones, BB is rapidly losing market share. BB OS has always been a very good, reliable and secure OS, but was never much of a multimedia device. The recently announced BBX OS update will completely revamp the BlackBerry as a device. It will run on the QNX platform which means that will not be backward compatible with OS7 devices. The OS7 update brings with it an upgraded graphics engine, voice activated search as well as NFC and a much better browser and HD video recording. RIM hopes that this upgrade will keep it in the running as a competitive OS.



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